

(Digital) Winter Count



Living catalog of a family's most important moments throughout the years.

This project was inspired, in part, by my ancestor Lone Dog of the Western Dakota (Sioux) Nation. He was the last known keeper of the winter count, a pictographic calendar that documented a tribe's most important moments over the years (pictured to the right).

This project initially started for the 'pro-sumers' of family content (i.e. my mom, my grandma) but over time became more for family members on the periphery

The frame consists of an e-ink display embedded in leather; family members were asked to contribute just one photo that represents an important moment for them



Lone Dog's winter count, via Plains Indians Museum

.The heirloom will then add a name and year to each photo and cycle through them in its display.

The design hopes to accomplish a couple of things: Firstly, it replaces the garish LCD picture frames that some of my family have; second, it acts as a filter for content, forcing people to choose the 'best' photo, almost as if they were making a physical picture book; and third, it invites people to engage in reflection on family outside of their phone (which, for family members far and wide, is really the only touchpoint for family updates).